

Christos Hadjinikolis

Engineering Manager | Data Platforms & Streaming Systems
Ph.D. Computer Science | UCL Research Associate | AI Standards
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profiles

[website](#)

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leadership

6 direct reports
team development
technical direction
delivery ownership

data platforms

Kafka/Flink
AWS/GCP
Python/Java/Kotlin
CI/CD/observability

ML/data systems

MLflow/PyTorch
graph analytics
data contracts
evaluation/replay

practice

ADRs/design reviews
local E2E testing
mentoring/hiring
stakeholder roadmaps

profile

Engineering Manager with 16 years across data platforms, streaming systems, production ML, consulting and AI research. I lead teams delivering reliable, observable services over complex real-world data. My background includes Kafka/Flink architecture, cloud ML-platform delivery, engineering standards, graph analytics and cross-functional roadmap ownership, supported by a Ph.D. in Computer Science.

experience

Vortexa Ltd, London, UK 12/2020–present

Engineering Manager | ML Systems Lead

Lead technical direction and delivery for a live data/ML estate processing **~6M vessel-position records/hour** for **13.5K monitored vessels**. Manage **6 direct reports** and lead a **10-person cross-functional team**. Engineering Manager since **02/2022**; joined as Senior ML Engineer.

- **Team Leadership:** Own performance and career development, hiring for six roles, and delivery across Data Science, Data Engineering, Product and domain analysis. Contributed hiring and engineering practices as the wider Data Production group grew from 4 to 30+.
- **Streaming Platform:** Led the **Kafka Streams-to-Flink** transition as a strategic platform move, improving maintainability, operational visibility and compute scaling independent of Kafka partitioning.
- **Production Data/ML Services:** Led delivery of versioned model-serving workflows and streaming enrichment for destination/arrival predictions; established MLflow, data/model versioning and monitoring for the live estate.
- **Engineering SDLC:** Standardised I/O seams, schema/data validation, repository patterns, ADRs and local end-to-end testing. Reduced a **3-hour DAG feedback loop to under 5 minutes**; maintained runbooks and rollback/fallback paths.
- **Data Quality & Evaluation:** Built batch/online evaluation and replay loops; investigated edge cases with domain experts and maintained signal-quality controls and live accuracy monitoring.
- **Roadmap & Design Reviews:** Led workshops and design discussions across Product, analysts and engineering to agree model-quality definitions, measurable objectives and delivery priorities.

DataReply, London, UK 04/2016–12/2020

Senior Consultant | Data Scientist / ML Engineer

Joined the London spin-off as its first consultant and contributed to its growth to **30+ consultants**. Progressed to Senior Consultant, leading client delivery, scoping roadmaps, mentoring colleagues and coordinating enterprise engagements.

- **Vodafone I Cloud ML Platform:** Led multi-workstream delivery on a GCP/Kubeflow-based data-science platform, covering CI/CD, workflow automation, feature engineering and ML lifecycle support.
- **UBS I Event Pipelines:** Delivered Kafka/Elasticsearch real-time pipelines, graph/process-mining analytics and observability; developed production engineering practice through XP and pair programming.
- **CNHi I Vehicle Data:** Guided a PySpark DS/DE team over live agricultural-vehicle telemetry, building time-series predictive-maintenance models and alerting on Azure/Databricks.

KCL, UCL, David Game College, UK 2010–2016

Teaching and Technical Training

Taught algorithms, data structures, databases/SQL and Java/Python; developed technical communication and mentoring practice.

education

2010–2014	Ph.D. in Computer Science <i>Thesis: Persuasion Dialogues & Opponent Modelling.</i> Developed logical inference methods for large knowledge graphs, combining symbolic reasoning, graph analytics and Bayesian techniques (MCMC) . Received Best Poster Award at IJCAI 2013 (413 submissions), EPSRC PhD Scholarship, Outstanding TA Award and Graduate Certificate in Academic Practice. Publications on Google Scholar	King's College London, UK
2004–2010	Diploma (BEng) in Computer Engineering Five-year polytechnic degree with a strong mathematics foundation. Majored in Artificial Intelligence.	University of Thessaly, GR
2002–2004	Military Officer: Second Lieutenant Completed national service as a commissioned Second Lieutenant.	National Guard, CY

research & AI standards

since 10/2024	University College London, Dept. of Information Studies Research and teach practical AI standardisation, including auditability, model/data versioning, explainability and responsible adoption.	Associate Researcher
since 2021	ISO / CEN-CENELEC AI standardisation Contribute to AI standards aligned with EU policy and international norms, with emphasis on traceability, explainability and model/data governance.	Committee Expert JTC 21, WG3

selected data & AI engineering work

PyPI	dynamicio Created a Python library for explicit I/O boundaries, schema/data validation and faster local pipeline tests; used across 15+ repositories .	Data contracts/testing
PyPI / JetBrains	skeleton-replay & plugin Python tool and IDE plugin for traces, architecture snapshots and replayable run reports.	Runtime evidence
Private project	Promet Local exploration of model runtimes, tool execution, approval controls, traces and replay for AI workflows; not presented as a production enterprise platform.	Applied AI tooling

selected talks & interviews

2023	Agile in Action Agile data science and engineering delivery at Vortexa.	Podcast Interview
2022	Open Data Science Conference dynamicio: abstracting I/O for ML workflows.	Industry Conference Talk

selected credentials

2016–2020	ML, cloud & data engineering AWS Machine Learning Specialty (2020); Google Professional Data Engineer (2017); Apache Spark Developer (2016).	AWS, Google Cloud, O'Reilly
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